

Early one morning

TRAD. ENGLISH

Slowly and sleepily [$\text{♩} = c.60$]

The piano score is written in 4/4 time and consists of four systems of staves. The first system (measures 1-3) is marked *mp* and features a slow, sleepily melody in the bass clef with fingerings 5, 4, 2, 2, 4, 2. The second system (measures 4-6) begins with a *rit.* (ritardando) marking and a *mf* (mezzo-forte) dynamic. It includes a *a tempo* marking and features more active melodic lines in both hands with fingerings 1, 3, 4, 4, 3. The third system (measures 7-9) continues the melodic development with fingerings 3, 1, 2, 4, 2 and a *mp* dynamic. The fourth system (measures 10-12) concludes the piece with a *p* (piano) dynamic and fingerings 2, 4. The score includes various musical notations such as slurs, ties, and fingering numbers.

This piece is a piano arrangement of a traditional English song, whose first verse reads:

Early one morning, just as the sun was rising,
I heard a maid sing in the valley below:
'Oh, don't deceive me; Oh, never leave me!
How could you use a poor maiden so?'